

Cream of Mushroom Mousse

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Ingredients

- 1 lb (about 450g) mixed mushrooms (cremini, button, or a mix)
- 4 Tbsp (50g) unsalted butter, divided
- 2 shallots, minced (or 1/4 cup finely chopped onion)
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 1/4 cup dry white wine (optional, for deglazing)
- 1 cup (235ml) heavy cream, divided
- Salt and freshly ground black pepper to taste
- Fresh parsley or thyme, chopped, for garnish (optional)

Instructions

1. Sauté the aromatics and mushrooms: In a large pan, melt 2 tablespoons of butter over medium heat. Add the shallots and garlic and cook until softened and fragrant, about 2-3 minutes. Add the sliced mushrooms and cook for 8-10 minutes, stirring occasionally, until they have released their moisture and started to brown.
2. Deglaze (optional) and simmer: If using, pour in the white wine and stir, scraping any bits from the bottom of the pan, and let it reduce by half. Add half of the heavy cream (1/2 cup) to the mushroom mixture and simmer over low heat until the mixture is thick, almost like a paste.
3. Blend the mixture: Remove the mixture from the heat and let it cool slightly. Transfer the mushroom mixture to a food processor or blender. Blend until very smooth. Season with salt and pepper to taste. Transfer the blended mixture to a bowl and refrigerate until completely cold.
4. Whip the remaining cream: In a separate, chilled bowl, whip the remaining 1/2 cup of heavy cream until stiff peaks form.
5. Fold and chill: Once both mixtures are completely cold, gently fold the whipped cream into the mushroom mixture in two batches, being careful not to deflate the mousse.
6. Set and serve: Transfer the mousse into a serving mold, individual ramekins, or a piping bag. Chill in the refrigerator for at least 1-2 hours until set.
Serve the mushroom mousse with crostini, crackers, or as a filling for tart shells. Garnish with fresh herbs before serving.